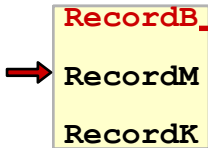


Attempting to batch-delete records in an unordered Sequential file

Click to view.

When viewing , left click (or press the Page Up key) to see the next frame and right click (or press Page Down) to see the previous frame.

Transaction File

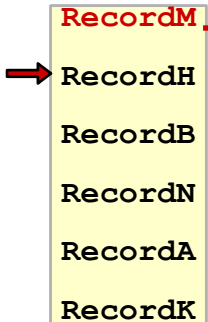


read

New Master File



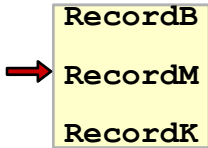
Master File



read

We start by reading
a record from each
file.

Transaction File



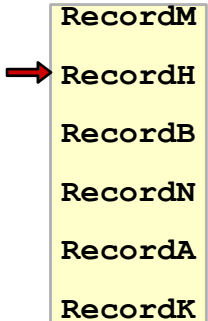
New Master File



writ
e

no

Master File



If the key fields in the records do not match, we don't need to delete this record, so we write it to the new file.

Transaction File

RecordB
RecordM
RecordK



New Master File

RecordM



RecordB
=
RecordH



Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordB
RecordN
RecordA
RecordK

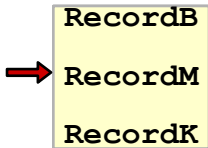


read

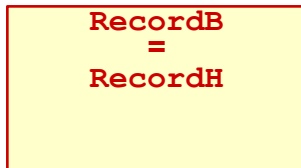


We have not yet found a match for the transaction file RecordB so we just need to get a record from the master file

Transaction File

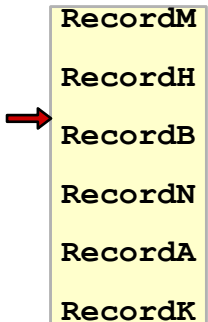


New Master File



write
no

Master File



These don't match either so we write RecordH to the new file and then we get a new record from the master file

Transaction File

RecordB
RecordM
RecordK



New Master File

RecordM
RecordH



Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordB
RecordN
RecordA
RecordK

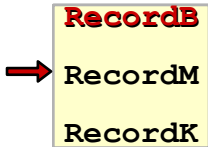


read

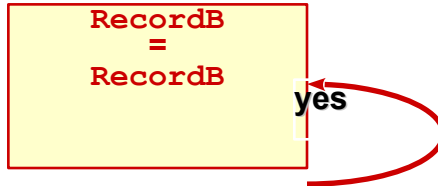
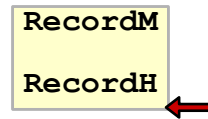
RecordB
=
RecordB



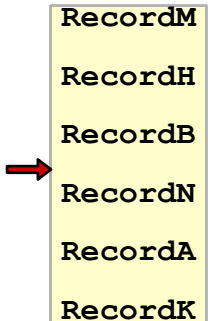
Transaction File



New Master File



Master File



We have a match!!

So we discard RecordB (by ignoring it) and get new records from the transaction and master files.

Transaction File

RecordB

RecordM

RecordK

read

New Master File

RecordM

RecordH

Master File

RecordM

RecordH

RecordB

RecordN

RecordA

RecordK

read

RecordM

=

RecordN



Once more the records don't match. So we need to write the master file record to the new master file, and get another record from the master file.

Transaction File

RecordB

RecordM

RecordK



New Master File

RecordM

RecordH

RecordN



RecordM
=
RecordN

writ
e
no

Master File

RecordM

RecordH

RecordB

RecordN

RecordA

RecordK



This
When the
we can't
the new
delete re

A similar problem occurs with batch updates on an unordered file. When we write a record to the new master file we can't be sure that there is not an update for the record further down the transaction file.